IDSS
Parent Guide
2026/2027

Internationale
Deutsche Schule
Sarajevo

IDSS

Parent Guide

2026 / 2027

Internationale Deutsche Schule Sarajevo

Buka 13, 71 000 Sarajevo | idss.edu.ba | info@idss.ba

This guide is updated annually. Please read carefully and sign the acknowledgement form.

★ **ISO 9001:2015 Certified**	★ **HACCP Food Safety Certified**	**Business Leader Sustainable Dev. 2025 – "People"**

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WELCOME LETTER

Dear Parents and Friends of the IDSS,

We are delighted to welcome you to the Internationale Deutsche Schule Sarajevo for the 2026/2027 school year. Whether you are joining us for the first time or returning as part of our community, we are glad you are here.

IDSS is a school built on high academic, ethical, and operational standards. We are proud holders of the ISO 9001:2015 Quality Management certification and HACCP Food Safety certification, and in 2025 we were honoured with the Business Leader of Sustainable Development Award in the category People, a recognition of our commitment to the wellbeing and growth of every individual in our community.

Our programme goes far beyond academic achievement. We nurture the whole child: intellectually curious, emotionally resilient, bilingual, and globally minded. We believe that a great school is built on trust, between teachers and students, and between the school and families. You are essential partners in your child's education, and this Guide is your practical companion for the year ahead.

Please read every section carefully, discuss the key expectations with your child, and return the signed acknowledgement form to the school office within the first week of school.

We look forward to a year of learning, growth, and shared achievement.

Sincerely,

Davor Mulalic

Davor Mulalic

Principal | IDSS Sarajevo | 2026

OUR VISION

IDSS aspires to be the school of choice for families who want more than a good education, they want an exceptional one. Our vision is to develop students who are:

Critical Thinkers who question, analyse, and solve	**Lifelong Learners** driven by curiosity and purpose	**Bilingual Communicators** fluent in German, proficient in English	**Global Citizens** compassionate, resilient, and responsible

We envision a school that prioritises the whole child, ensuring individualised attention and support in academic, social-emotional, physical, and creative development. Learning at IDSS is hands-on, project-based, and collaborative. Our curriculum meets the highest standards of German education while celebrating the cultural richness of our diverse, international community.

OUR MISSION

The mission of IDSS is to nurture every child's potential, cultivate a love of learning, and prepare students for success in a diverse and rapidly changing world. We pursue this mission through six interconnected commitments:

01 Safe & Inclusive Environment Every student feels valued, respected, and empowered to learn, regardless of background, language, or ability.	**02 Rigorous Academic Curriculum** Critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving across all subjects, aligned to German federal education standards.
03 German Language & Culture Deep immersion in German language, history, and culture through authentic experiences from the earliest age.	**04 Character & Social Responsibility** Empathy, integrity, leadership, and global citizenship developed through community service and role modelling.
05 Bilingual Excellence Fluency in German and proficiency in English, a proven foundation for cognitive development and future success.	**06 Family Partnership** Active parent involvement through regular communication, meetings, curriculum updates, and school events.

In everything we do, we are guided by three principles: quality without compromise, respect for every individual, and the belief that education is a partnership. Our ISO 9001:2015 certification reflects our institutional commitment to these principles, every process, every interaction, every meal is held to the highest standard.

School contacts

Internationale Deutsche Schule Sarajevo Buka 13, 71 000 Sarajevo, BiH idss.edu.ba General: info@idss.ba Pedagogy: pedagogy@idss.ba	**Phone (General)** +387 33 560 520 **EMERGENCY LINE, 24/7** **+387 60 345 1275** *Use for: urgent safety concerns, last-minute pick-up changes, arrival outside gate hours.*

Staff Email Addresses

Every staff member holds a personal @idss.ba email address, shared with families at the start of the school year. You may contact administration, teachers, and support staff at any time.

Response time: within 24 hours on weekdays.

Emails sent on Friday or over the weekend will be answered on Monday.

For matters that need more than a brief exchange, please email to schedule a meeting.

Extended face-to-face conversations are always more effective than lengthy email threads.

Communication within IDSS

Who to Contact, Quick Reference

Please direct your question or concern to the person best placed to help. Going directly to the right contact saves time for everyone.

Topic	Contact
Day-to-day classroom matters	Class teacher, email or scheduled meeting
Absence notification	info@idss.ba AND class teacher (same day)
Academic progress & assessments	Class teacher, schedule a meeting
Pedagogical concerns / curriculum	Head of Education, pedagogy@idss.ba
Administrative matters, fees, documents	School Secretary, info@idss.ba
Serious complaints or unresolved issues	Principal, schedule a meeting via email

Last-minute pick-up / emergency	+387 60 345 1275 (call, do not email)

Communication Rules

- Do not visit teachers in their classrooms without a prior appointment. Teachers use this time to prepare lessons, review student work, and support individual students.
- Conversations expected to last more than 5 minutes must be scheduled by email in advance.
- All concerns must be raised through the appropriate channel above. Social media posts or group-chat complaints are not an appropriate substitute and are covered under the Parent Code of Conduct.

School secretary

The school secretary is based at the main gate throughout the school day. She is the first point of contact for arriving parents and manages visitor access, ensuring that only authorised individuals enter the school grounds. She can assist with policies, schedules, administrative queries, and general information.

Secretary Consultation Hours

Day	Hours
Monday – Thursday	09:00 – 11:00 and 14:45 – 15:45
Friday	09:00 – 11:00

Reachable by phone and email throughout the day:

+387 33 560 520 | info@idss.ba

Parent–teacher meetings

Formal parent–teacher meetings are held twice per year. Dates are communicated by email well in advance.

- **Autumn meeting** (November), early-year progress, expectations, and any emerging concerns.
- **Spring meeting** (April), second-semester progress and end-of-year outlook.

Each slot is 15 minutes. If a topic requires more time, arrange a separate dedicated meeting directly with the teacher, do not attempt to extend the formal slot.

CURRICULUM UPDATES & NEWSLETTER

- **Curriculum updates** are sent by teachers several times per year. Each update outlines the subjects and topics currently being taught and suggests ways families can support learning at home.
- **School newsletters** are issued twice per year, at the end of each semester, covering school life, student achievements, upcoming events, and community news.
- All communications are sent by email. Please ensure your contact details are up to date and that emails from idss.ba do not go to your spam folder.

Safety First

A safe environment is the foundation of everything we do at IDSS. Safety at our school is physical, emotional, digital, and operational, and it is everyone's shared responsibility. Our safety framework is embedded in our ISO 9001:2015 quality management system and reviewed continuously throughout the year.

EMERGENCY, 24/7 **+387 60 345 1275** *Call immediately for any urgent safety concern.*	**General Enquiries** +387 33 560 520 info@idss.ba	**Ambulance / Police / Fire** 124 / 122 / 123 *IDSS staff will call on your behalf if needed.*

Our Six Safety Pillars

Access Control	The main gate is locked for most of the day. Entry is permitted only during designated drop-off and pick-up windows. All visitors must be authorised and are monitored by the school secretary.
Trained Staff	All staff are trained to identify and respond to safety concerns before they escalate. Emergency procedures are reviewed at the start of each school year.
Emergency Drills	Regular fire, evacuation, and lockdown drills are conducted throughout the year. Students and staff practise procedures so that responses are automatic and calm.
Mental Health Support	Counselling and wellbeing support is available for students experiencing stress, anxiety, or personal difficulties. Staff are attentive to emotional as well as physical safety.
Grounds Inspection	School grounds and facilities are inspected regularly for potential hazards. Any issues are addressed promptly in line with ISO 9001:2015 quality management protocols.
Digital Safety	Students receive age-appropriate education on responsible and safe use of technology, both in and outside the classroom. Mobile phones are not permitted at school.

Gate Opening Hours

The main gate is locked for most of the school day. It opens only during the following windows:

- **07:30 – 09:00** Morning drop-off window
- **14:40 – 17:00** Afternoon pick-up window

> If you arrive outside these hours, call: +387 60 345 1275 or +387 33 560 520.
>
> Do not leave your child unattended at a closed gate.

Visitor Access

All visitors to IDSS, including parents, must be authorised. The school secretary monitors the gate and verifies the identity of anyone entering the school grounds. Staff may request a photo ID from any person not previously known to them. Unauthorised individuals will not be permitted entry.

Ambulance Intervention

In the event of a serious injury or medical emergency involving a student, staff will immediately call emergency services (124). Parents are notified as soon as the call has been made. IDSS staff are not authorised to determine which hospital the student is taken to, that decision rests solely with the emergency physician.

> In a medical emergency: staff call 124 first, then inform parents immediately.
>
> IDSS staff cannot override decisions made by the emergency physician.

Student Wellbeing & Mental Health

Physical safety is inseparable from emotional safety. IDSS provides counselling and wellbeing support for students experiencing stress, anxiety, or personal difficulties. Our staff are trained to recognise early signs of emotional difficulty and to respond with care and discretion. Parents are encouraged to inform the school of any significant changes in a child's home situation that may affect their wellbeing at school.

Digital Safety

Students are educated in responsible, ethical, and safe use of technology as part of their regular curriculum. Mobile phones are not permitted on school premises. Any concerns related to cyberbullying, inappropriate online content, or digital harassment should be reported immediately to the class teacher or Head of Education.

Parent Responsibilities

School safety depends on active cooperation from families. Parents are required to:

- Respect all gate access procedures and never attempt to enter outside authorised hours without calling first.
- Keep the school's authorised escort list up to date at all times (see Drop-off & Pick-up section).
- Inform the school immediately of any medical condition, allergy, or personal circumstance that may affect their child's safety.
- Never share access codes, gate procedures, or internal school information with unauthorised persons.
- Report any safety concern, however minor it may seem, to school staff promptly.

ACADEMIC CALENDAR 2026/2027

The calendar below is based on the official Decision on the School Calendar for 2026/2027, adopted by the Director of IDSS in accordance with the Statute of P.U. Internationale Deutsche Schule Sarajevo, the Law on Primary Education of Sarajevo Canton, and the Law on Preschool Education of Sarajevo Canton. The full graphic calendar is available on the school website: idss.edu.ba

School year: 1 September 2026 – 21 June 2027

Semester 1: 1 Sep 2026 – 31 Jan 2027

Semester 2: 1 Feb 2027 – 21 Jun 2027

Preparation Week (staff only): 18 – 31 August 2026 | No students.

Full Year Calendar, Key Dates

Colour guide: School Holiday (orange) • Public Holiday (red) • Non-teaching day (blue) • Event (purple) • Project (green)

Period	Dates	Type	Notes
Preparation Week	18 – 31 Aug 2026	**Non-teaching**	Staff only. No students.
First Day of School	Tue, 1 Sep 2026	**School**	Grades 1–9 begin
Parents Evening (1–9)	Fri, 25 Sep 2026	**Event**	Alt. date: Mon 28 Sep
Parents Evening (Pre.)	Mon, 28 Sep 2026	**Event**	Preschool Group
German Unity Day	Sat, 3 Oct 2026	**Public Holiday**	Non-teaching day
Autumn Holidays	19 – 23 Oct 2026	**School Holiday**	Students free; staff working
Halloween	Sat, 31 Oct 2026	**Event**	Creative activity at school
Statehood Day BiH	Wed, 25 Nov 2026	**Public Holiday**	School closed
Thanksgiving Day	Thu, 26 Nov 2026	**Event**	Intercultural celebration
Laternenfest	Wed, 11 Nov 2026	**Event**	St Martin's lantern festival
Winter Celebration	Fri, 11 Dec 2026	**Event**	Inclusive end-of-term event
Catholic Christmas	Fri, 25 Dec 2026	**Public Holiday**	School closed

Winter Holidays	21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	**School Holiday**	Incl. Christmas & New Year
New Year's Day	Fri, 1 Jan 2027	**Public Holiday**	School closed
Orthodox Christmas	Thu, 7 Jan 2027	**Public Holiday**	School closed
Semester 2 Begins	Mon, 1 Feb 2027	**School**	Grades 1–9
Carnival	Mon, 8 Feb 2027	**Event**	German school tradition
Parents Evening (1–9)	Fri, 19 Feb 2027	**Event**	Alt. date: Mon 22 Feb
Parents Evening (Pre.)	Mon, 22 Feb 2027	**Event**	Preschool Group
Independence Day BiH	Mon, 1 Mar 2027	**Public Holiday**	School closed
Women's Day	Mon, 8 Mar 2027	**Event**	Awareness activity
Eid al-Fitr	Tue, 9 Mar 2027	**Public Holiday**	School closed
Spring Holidays	29 Mar – 2 Apr 2027	**School Holiday**	Students free; staff working
Catholic Easter	Sun, 28 Mar 2027	**Public Holiday**	School closed
Open Day	Fri, 26 Mar 2027	**Event**	Students as ambassadors
Preschool Staff Training	Fri, 16 Apr 2027	**Non-teaching**	Preschool Group closed only
Labor Day	Sat, 1 May & Mon 3 May 2027	**Public Holiday**	School closed Mon 3 May
Orthodox Easter	Mon, 3 May 2027	**Public Holiday**	School closed
Eid al-Adha	Sun 16 & Mon 17 May 2027	**Public Holiday**	School closed Mon 17 May
Mother's Day	Sat, 9 May 2027	**Event**	Classroom activity
Reading Day	Thu, 14 May 2027	**Event**	Promotes reading culture
Project Week	22 – 25 May 2027	**Project**	Interdisciplinary learning week
Sports Day	Thu, 4 Jun 2027	**Event**	Physical activity day
Summerfest	Thu, 11 Jun 2027	**Event**	End-of-year celebration
Last Day of School	Mon, 21 Jun 2027	**School**	Grades 1–9
Summer Holidays	22 Jun – 31 Aug 2027	**School Holiday**	Students
Summer School	2 – 13 Aug 2027	**Project**	Optional. Ages 6–15.

School Holidays, Summary

Holiday	Dates	Note
Autumn Holidays	19 – 23 Oct 2026	Students free. Staff report to school as per Director's schedule.
Winter Holidays	21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027	Includes Catholic Christmas, Orthodox Christmas, and New Year's Day.
Spring Holidays	29 Mar – 2 Apr 2027	Students free. Staff report to school as per Director's schedule.
Summer Holidays	22 Jun – 31 Aug 2027	Longest break. Summer School runs 2–13 Aug (optional).

IMPORTANT, Holidays for staff vs. students:

Autumn Holidays (19–23 Oct) and Spring Holidays (29 Mar–2 Apr) are non-teaching days for students,

but ALL staff (teachers, support, administration) continue to work according to the Director's schedule.

Only the Winter Holidays and Summer Holidays are full closures for both students and staff.

Public Holidays, School Closed

IDSS observes the following official public holidays, reflecting the multicultural character of our school and BiH law. On these days the school is closed for both students and staff.

Holiday	Date	Context
Statehood Day (BiH)	Wed, 25 Nov 2026	Foundation of ZAVNOBiH, 1943
Catholic Christmas	Fri, 25 Dec 2026	Christian holiday
New Year's Day	Fri, 1 Jan 2027	Civic and cultural holiday
Orthodox Christmas	Thu, 7 Jan 2027	Julian calendar Christmas
Independence Day (BiH)	Mon, 1 Mar 2027	1992 independence referendum
Eid al-Fitr	Tue, 9 Mar 2027	End of Ramadan
Labor Day	Mon, 3 May 2027	International Labour Day
Orthodox Easter	Mon, 3 May 2027	Combined with Labour Day
Eid al-Adha	Mon, 17 May 2027	Feast of Sacrifice

School Events

The following school events are scheduled throughout the year. They contribute to students' holistic, cultural, social, and emotional development. Details and preparation notes are communicated by email in advance of each event.

Event	Date	Description
Parents Evening (Gr.1–9)	Fri 25 Sep / Mon 28 Sep 2026	1st formal meeting; alt. date if needed
German Unity Day	Sat, 3 Oct 2026	Non-teaching; European history context
Halloween	Sat, 31 Oct 2026	Creative expression; Anglo-Saxon tradition
Laternenfest	Wed, 11 Nov 2026	St Martin's lantern festival
Thanksgiving Day	Thu, 26 Nov 2026	Intercultural; gratitude & community
Winter Celebration	Fri, 11 Dec 2026	Inclusive; student performances
Carnival	Mon, 8 Feb 2027	German school tradition; creativity
Parents Evening (Gr.1–9)	Fri 19 Feb / Mon 22 Feb 2027	2nd formal meeting; alt. date if needed
Women's Day	Mon, 8 Mar 2027	Gender equality awareness
Open Day	Fri, 26 Mar 2027	Students as school ambassadors
Mother's Day	Sat, 9 May 2027	Classroom gratitude activity
Reading Day	Thu, 14 May 2027	Promotes reading culture
Project Week	22–25 May 2027	Interdisciplinary; teamwork; presentations
Sports Day	Thu, 4 Jun 2027	Physical activity; team spirit; fair play
Summerfest	Thu, 11 Jun 2027	End-of-year celebration; student awards

Special Note, IDSS Preschool Group

The IDSS Preschool Group operates within IDSS but follows the calendar of the International Montessori House (IMH). This means certain closures and open days differ from those of Grades 1–9. The table below lists all dates where the Preschool Group schedule differs from the main school calendar.

Date	Note for Preschool Families
Fri, 25 Sep 2026	Staff Training Day (IMH). PRESCHOOL CLOSED. Parents are required to arrange alternative care. Written notice given ≥14 days in advance.
19–23 Oct 2026	Autumn Holidays for Grades 1–9. PRESCHOOL REMAINS OPEN, follows IMH calendar.

Fri, 16 Apr 2027	Staff Training Day (IMH). PRESCHOOL CLOSED. Parents are required to arrange alternative care. Written notice given ≥14 days in advance.
29 Mar – 2 Apr 2027	Spring Holidays for Grades 1–9. PRESCHOOL follows IMH calendar, check IMH schedule for closures.

> At the start of each school year, the Director publishes a written, synchronised operational calendar for the IDSS Preschool Group (Attachment II, available on idss.edu.ba).
>
> Preschool families are notified of any Staff Training closures at least 14 days in advance.

Calendar Amendments

The Director of IDSS reserves the right to amend individual dates in response to exceptional circumstances, with prior written notice to parents and staff. All amendments are published promptly on idss.edu.ba. In case of school closure due to severe weather, IDSS follows the guidance of public schools in Sarajevo Canton (http://mon.ks.gov.ba/pocetna) and notifies families by email.

Internationale Deutsche Schule Sarajevo

School Calendar 2026/2027

2026				2027							
September	October	November	December	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August
1 Tu First Day of School	1 Th	1 Su	1 Tu	1 Fr New Year's Day	1 Mo First Day of Second Semester	1 Mo Independence Day BH	1 Th Spring Holidays	1 Sa Labor Day	1 Tu	1 Th	1 Su Summer Holiday
2 We	2 Fr	2 Mo	2 We	2 Sa Winter Holidays	2 Tu	2 Tu	2 Fr	2 Su Orthodox Easter Labor Day	2 We	2 Fr	2 Mo Summer School
3 Th	3 Sa German Unity Day	3 Tu	3 Th	3 Su	3 We	3 We	3 Sa	3 Mo Labor Day	3 Th	3 Sa	3 Tu
4 Fr	4 Su	4 We	4 Fr	4 Mo	4 Th	4 Th	4 Su	4 Tu	4 Fr Sports Day	4 Su	4 We
5 Sa	5 Mo World Teachers' Day	5 Th	5 Sa	5 Tu	5 Fr	5 Fr	5 Mo	5 We	5 Sa	5 Mo	5 Th
6 Su	6 Tu	6 Fr	6 Su	6 We	6 Sa	6 Sa	6 Tu	6 Th	6 Su	6 Tu	6 Fr
7 Mo	7 We	7 Sa	7 Mo	7 Th Orthodox Christmas Day	7 Su	7 Su	7 We	7 Fr	7 Mo	7 We	7 Sa Summer Holidays
8 Tu	8 Th	8 Su	8 Tu	8 Fr	8 Mo Carnival	8 Mo Women's Day	8 Th	8 Sa	8 Tu	8 Th	8 Su
9 We	9 Fr	9 Mo	9 We	9 Sa	9 Tu	9 Tu Eid al-Fitr	9 Fr	9 Su Mother's Day	9 We	9 Fr	9 Mo Summer School
10 Th	10 Sa	10 Tu	10 Th	10 Su	10 We	10 We	10 Sa	10 Mo	10 Th	10 Sa	10 Tu
11 Fr	11 Su	11 We Laternentest	11 Fr Winter Celebration	11 Mo	11 Th	11 Th	11 Su	11 Tu	11 Fr Summerfest	11 Su	11 We
12 Sa	12 Mo	12 Th	12 Sa	12 Tu	12 Fr	12 Fr	12 Mo	12 We	12 Sa	12 Mo	12 Th
13 Su	13 Tu	13 Fr	13 Su	13 We	13 Sa	13 Sa	13 Tu	13 Th	13 Su	13 Tu	13 Fr
14 Mo	14 We	14 Sa	14 Mo	14 Th	14 Su	14 Su	14 We	14 Fr Reading Day	14 Mo	14 We	14 Sa Summer Holidays
15 Tu	15 Th	15 Su	15 Tu	15 Fr	15 Mo	15 Mo	15 Th	15 Sa	15 Tu	15 Th	15 Su
16 We	16 Fr	16 Mo	16 We	16 Sa	16 Tu	16 Tu	16 Fr	16 Su Eid al-Adha	16 We	16 Fr	16 Mo
17 Th	17 Sa	17 Tu	17 Th	17 Su	17 We	17 We	17 Sa	17 Mo Eid al-Adha	17 Th	17 Sa	17 Tu
18 Fr	18 Su	18 We	18 Fr	18 Mo	18 Th	18 Th	18 Su	18 Tu	18 Fr	18 Su	18 We Preparation week
19 Sa	19 Mo	19 Th	19 Sa	19 Tu	19 Fr Parent Evening	19 Fr	19 Mo	19 We	19 Sa	19 Mo	19 Th
20 Su	20 Tu Autumn Holidays	20 Fr	20 Su	20 We	20 Sa	20 Sa	20 Tu	20 Th	20 Su	20 Tu	20 Fr
21 Mo	21 We	21 Sa	21 Mo Winter Holidays	21 Th	21 Su	21 Su	21 We	21 Fr	21 Mo Last Day of School	21 We	21 Sa Summer Holidays
22 Tu	22 Th	22 Su	22 Tu	22 Fr	22 Mo	22 Mo Project Week	22 Th	22 Sa	22 Tu Summer Holidays	22 Th	22 Su
23 We	23 Fr	23 Mo	23 We	23 Sa	23 Tu	23 Tu	23 Fr	23 Su	23 We	23 Fr	23 Mo Preparation Week
24 Th	24 Sa	24 Tu	24 Th	24 Su	24 We	24 We	24 Sa	24 Mo	24 Th	24 Sa	24 Tu
25 Fr Parents Evening	25 Su	25 We Statehood Day BH	25 Fr Catholic Christmas Day	25 Mo	25 Th	25 Th	25 Su	25 Tu	25 Fr	25 Su	25 We
26 Sa	26 Mo	26 Th Thanksgiving Day	26 Sa Winter Holidays	26 Tu	26 Fr	26 Fr Open Day	26 Mo	26 We	26 Sa	26 Mo	26 Th
27 Su	27 Tu	27 Fr	27 Su	27 We	27 Sa	27 Sa	27 Tu	27 Th	27 Su	27 Tu	27 Fr
28 Mo	28 We	28 Sa	28 Mo	28 Th	28 Su	28 Su Catholic Easter	28 We	28 Fr	28 Mo	28 We	28 Sa
29 Tu	29 Th	29 Su	29 Tu	29 Fr Last Day of First Semester		29 Mo Spring Holidays	29 Th	29 Sa	29 Tu	29 Th	29 Su
30 We	30 Fr	30 Mo	30 We	30 Sa		30 Tu	30 Fr	30 Su	30 We	30 Fr	30 Mo
	31 Sa Halloween		31 Th	31 Su		31 We		31 Mo		31 Sa	31 Tu

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Data provided 'as is' without warranty

Non-working days	Statehood Day BH, Catholic Christmas Day, New Year's Day, Orthodox Christmas Day, Independence Day BH, Eid al-Fitr, Catholic/Orthodox Easter, Labor Day, Eid al-Adha
Events	Parents Evening, German Unity Day, Halloween, Laternentest, Thanksgiving Day, Winter Celebration, Carnival, Open Day, Reading Day, Sports Day, Summerfest
Holidays	Autumn, Winter, Spring, Summer
Non-teaching Days	German Unity Day, Autumn Holidays, Spring Holidays
Projects	Project Week, Summer School

Internationale Deutsche Schule Sarajevo

IDSS Preschool Calendar 2026/2027

The Montessori House

2026				2027							
September	October	November	December	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August
1 Tu	1 Th	1 Su	1 Tu	1 Fr New Year's Day	1 Mo	1 Mo Independence Day BH	1 Th Spring Holidays	1 Sa Labor Day	1 Tu	1 Th	1 Su
2 We	2 Fr	2 Mo	2 We	2 Sa Winter Holidays	2 Tu	2 Tu	2 Fr	2 Su Orthodox Easter Labor Day	2 We	2 Fr	2 Mo
3 Th	3 Sa German Unity Day	3 Tu	3 Th	3 Su	3 We	3 We	3 Sa	3 Mo Labor Day	3 Th	3 Sa	3 Tu
4 Fr	4 Su	4 We	4 Fr	4 Mo	4 Th	4 Th	4 Su	4 Tu	4 Fr Sports Day	4 Su	4 We
5 Sa	5 Mo	5 Th	5 Sa	5 Tu	5 Fr	5 Fr	5 Mo	5 We	5 Sa	5 Mo	5 Th
6 Su	6 Tu	6 Fr	6 Su	6 We	6 Sa	6 Sa	6 Tu	6 Th	6 Su	6 Tu	6 Fr
7 Mo	7 We	7 Sa	7 Mo	7 Th Orthodox Christmas Day	7 Su	7 Su	7 We	7 Fr	7 Mo	7 We	7 Sa
8 Tu	8 Th	8 Su	8 Tu	8 Fr	8 Mo Carnival	8 Mo Women's Day	8 Th	8 Sa	8 Tu	8 Th	8 Su
9 We	9 Fr	9 Mo	9 We	9 Sa	9 Tu	9 Tu Eid al-Fitr	9 Fr	9 Su Mother's Day	9 We	9 Fr	9 Mo
10 Th	10 Sa	10 Tu	10 Th	10 Su	10 We	10 We	10 Sa	10 Mo	10 Th	10 Sa	10 Tu
11 Fr	11 Su	11 We Laternenfest	11 Fr Winter Celebration	11 Mo	11 Th	11 Th	11 Su	11 Tu	11 Fr Summerfest	11 Su	11 We
12 Sa	12 Mo	12 Th	12 Sa	12 Tu	12 Fr	12 Fr	12 Mo	12 We	12 Sa	12 Mo	12 Th
13 Su	13 Tu	13 Fr	13 Su	13 We	13 Sa	13 Sa	13 Tu	13 Th	13 Su	13 Tu	13 Fr
14 Mo	14 We	14 Sa	14 Mo	14 Th	14 Su	14 Su	14 We	14 Fr Reading Day	14 Mo	14 We	14 Sa
15 Tu	15 Th	15 Su	15 Tu	15 Fr	15 Mo	15 Mo	15 Th	15 Sa	15 Tu	15 Th	15 Su
16 We	16 Fr	16 Mo	16 We	16 Sa	16 Tu	16 Tu	16 Fr Staff Training	16 Su Eid al-Adha	16 We	16 Fr	16 Mo
17 Th	17 Sa	17 Tu	17 Th	17 Su	17 We	17 We	17 Sa	17 Mo Eid al-Adha	17 Th	17 Sa	17 Tu
18 Fr	18 Su	18 We	18 Fr	18 Mo	18 Th	18 Th	18 Su	18 Tu	18 Fr	18 Su	18 We
19 Sa	19 Mo	19 Th	19 Sa	19 Tu	19 Fr	19 Fr	19 Mo	19 We	19 Sa	19 Mo	19 Th
20 Su	20 Tu	20 Fr	20 Su	20 We	20 Sa	20 Sa	20 Tu	20 Th	20 Su	20 Tu	20 Fr
21 Mo	21 We	21 Sa	21 Mo	21 Th	21 Su	21 Su	21 We	21 Fr	21 Mo	21 We	21 Sa
22 Tu	22 Th	22 Su	22 Tu Winter Holidays	22 Fr	22 Mo Parent Evening	22 Mo	22 Th	22 Sa	22 Tu	22 Th	22 Su
23 We	23 Fr	23 Mo	23 We	23 Sa	23 Tu	23 Tu Project Week	23 Fr	23 Su	23 We	23 Fr Summer Holidays	23 Mo
24 Th	24 Sa	24 Tu	24 Th	24 Su	24 We	24 We	24 Sa	24 Mo	24 Th	24 Sa	24 Tu
25 Fr Staff Training	25 Su	25 We Statehood Day BH	25 Fr Catholic Christmas Day	25 Mo	25 Th	25 Th	25 Su	25 Tu	25 Fr	25 Su	25 We
26 Sa	26 Mo	26 Th Thanksgiving Day	26 Sa	26 Tu	26 Fr	26 Fr Open Day	26 Mo	26 We	26 Sa	26 Mo	26 Th
27 Su	27 Tu	27 Fr	27 Su	27 We	27 Sa	27 Sa	27 Tu	27 Th	27 Su	27 Tu	27 Fr
28 Mo Parents Evening	28 We	28 Sa	28 Mo	28 Th	28 Su	28 Su Catholic Easter	28 We	28 Fr	28 Mo	28 We	28 Sa
29 Tu	29 Th	29 Su	29 Tu	29 Fr		29 Mo Spring Holidays	29 Th	29 Sa	29 Tu	29 Th	29 Su
30 We	30 Fr	30 Mo	30 We	30 Sa		30 Tu	30 Fr	30 Su	30 We	30 Fr	30 Mo
	31 Sa Halloween		31 Th	31 Su		31 We		31 Mo		31 Sa	31 Tu

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Non-working days	Staff Training, Statehood Day BH, Catholic Christmas Day, New Year's Day, Orthodox Christmas Day, Independence Day BH, Eid al-Fitr, Catholic/Orthodox Easter, Labor Day, Eid al-Adha
Events	Parents Evening, Halloween, Laternenfest, Thanksgiving Day, Winter Celebration, Carnival, Summerfest
Holidays	Winter, Spring, Summer
Projects	Project Week

School hours

IDSS is open for students from 07:30 to 17:00, every working day. The school day is structured to maximise focused learning, balanced with regular breaks for nutrition, physical activity, and social connection. Each teaching period is 45 minutes, with 5-minute transitions between subjects.

Time	Activity
07:30	School opens, drop-off begins for all grades
07:30 – 07:55	Arrival window, students settle, prepare for the day
07:55	LATEST ARRIVAL, students must be seated and ready
08:00	Lessons begin, Period 1
08:00 – 08:45	Period 1 (with 5-min transitions between subjects)
08:45 – 09:05	Breakfast break
09:00	Main gate locked
09:05 – 11:30	Morning lessons (with 5-min transitions between subjects)
11:30 – 12:15	Lunch
12:15 – 14:40	Afternoon lessons (with 5-min transitions between subjects)
14:40	Regular pick-up, students not enrolled in Afterschool Programme
14:40 – 15:15	Snack + break (Afterschool Programme students)
15:15 – 17:00	Afterschool Programme
16:30 – 17:00	Afterschool Programme pick-up window
17:00	School closes

PUNCTUALITY RULE, based on the IDSS Rulebook on School House Rules (Art. 10):

Students must arrive at school no later than 5 minutes before the start of classes.

This means students must be SEATED AND READY at 07:55 for the 08:00 lesson.

A student who arrives more than 5 minutes after the start of a lesson (i.e. after 08:05)

will NOT be admitted to the ongoing lesson.

They will wait in a supervised area and join at the beginning of the next period.

All delays are recorded daily by the class teacher.

Attendance

Regular school attendance is a legal obligation and a condition for academic success. Families are responsible for ensuring their child arrives on time and attends school every day. Attendance records are maintained by the class teacher and the school pedagogue.

Reporting an Absence

If a student is absent, the following procedure must be followed:

- **Same day:** Send an email to info@idss.ba AND the class teacher, stating the date and reason for the absence.
- **Absence of exactly 2 days:** Inform the Head of Education AND the class teacher by email.
- **Planned absence (non-illness):** Submit a written request at least 7 days in advance. Deliver to the school secretary directly or via the class teacher. The class teacher will respond within 2 working days.
- **Specialist medical appointment:** Notify the class teacher in advance. A medical note or referral must be submitted no later than 2 days after the student returns to school.
- **Frequent illness absences:** A medical certificate is required.

> Parent self-justification limit:
>
> A parent/guardian may personally justify an absence without a medical note for a maximum of 2 days per semester (4 days per school year).
>
> All other absences require written documentation.

Approved Absence, Who Can Authorise

Duration	Authorised by	How to request
Single lesson (emergency)	Subject teacher	Verbal, teacher contacts parent
Up to 3 working days	Class teacher	Written request, min. 7 days in advance
Up to 5 working days	Principal	Written request, min. 7 days in advance
Up to 15 working days	Teaching Council	Written request, min. 7 days in advance

Unexcused Absences, Consequences

Unexcused absence is classified as a serious breach of student duty under IDSS regulations and BiH law. The following disciplinary measures apply automatically based on the cumulative number of unexcused hours per school year:

Unexcused Hours	Disciplinary Measure	Conduct Grade
0 – 5	None	Exemplary (primjerno)
6 – 10	Class teacher reprimand	Very good (vrlo dobro)
11 – 19	Class council reprimand	Good (dobro)
20 – 26	Director reprimand	Satisfactory (zadovoljava)
26 – 30	Teaching council reprimand	Poor (loše)
31+	**EXPULSION from school**	N/A

An absence is UNEXCUSED when:

- No medical note or written justification has been submitted to the class teacher.
- The parent did not request and receive prior written approval.
- The parent's self-justification limit (2 days/semester) has already been used.

At the end of each semester, the class teacher and school pedagogue prepare an individual absence report for every student. The attendance register is maintained by the school pedagogue.

Tardiness

Students are expected to be seated and ready to work by 07:55. Classes begin at 08:00. A student who arrives more than 5 minutes after the start of a lesson will not be admitted to the ongoing lesson and will wait in a supervised area until the next period begins. All delays are recorded daily.

Repeated tardiness without justification is treated as a conduct issue and will result in a meeting with parents. Patterns of tardiness may be recorded as partial unexcused absences at the discretion of the class teacher.

School Closure Due to Bad Weather

In the event of severe weather, IDSS follows the guidance of public schools in Sarajevo Canton. If public schools are closed, IDSS is closed as well. Families will be notified by email. For updates, check: http://mon.ks.gov.ba/pocetna

PROCEDURES FOR DROP-OFF AND PICK-UP

The following procedures are based on the IDSS Procedure on Student Departure After Regular Classes, the Rulebook on School House Rules, and applicable BiH education law. Their purpose is to ensure the maximum safety of every student and the smooth, orderly flow of traffic in the school yard. All staff and all families are required to follow these procedures consistently.

Main Gate Opening Hours

The main gate is locked for most of the school day. It opens only during authorised drop-off and pick-up windows. The janitor manages parking access during the afternoon.

Time	Gate Status	Purpose
07:30 – 09:00	OPEN	Morning drop-off
09:00 – 14:30	**LOCKED**	No entry/exit
14:30	Parking gate opens	Max. 2 vehicles at a time (janitor)
14:40 – 17:00	OPEN	Afternoon pick-up
14:55	Parking gate closes	After pick-up is complete
17:00	**LOCKED**	School closes

> If you arrive outside gate hours, call: +387 60 345 1275 or +387 33 560 520.
>
> Do not leave your child unattended at a closed or locked gate under any circumstances.

Morning Drop-Off Procedure

Drop-off window: 07:30 – 09:00. The gate locks at 09:00.

1. Parents may accompany their child to the wardrobe area at the school entrance door.
2. **Parents are required to not proceed beyond the wardrobe area**, no entry into hallways or upstairs. This supports student independence and keeps the school building secure.
3. Students change immediately into their indoor shoes in the wardrobe.
4. **Students must be seated and ready to learn by 07:55** for the 08:00 lesson start.

> INDOOR SHOES, MANDATORY:
>
> Every student must bring and wear indoor shoes inside the school building every day.

Outdoor shoes are stored in the wardrobe. This rule applies to ALL grades, ALL days.

Please label your child's indoor shoes with their full name.

Afternoon Pick-Up Procedure (14:45)

This procedure applies to all students who are not enrolled in the Afterschool Programme. It is based on the official IDSS Procedure on Student Departure After Regular Classes.

GENERAL PRINCIPLES:

- All students not in the Afterschool Programme must be collected by a parent/guardian at 14:45.
- Students may NOT remain in the school yard unsupervised.
- Parents/guardians must collect their child in person, staff cannot hand over children outside this procedure.
- Responsibility for the child transfers to the parent/guardian at the moment of personal collection.
- Students with a Declaration of Independent Departure on file may leave independently at 14:40.

Step-by-step procedure:

5. At 14:40, the teacher ends the lesson and accompanies students to the school exit.
6. Afterschool Programme students are directed immediately to the responsible educator.
7. Parents wait in the schoolyard in front of the school door.
8. For Grades 1 and 2: teachers accompany students to the wardrobe, where they prepare for pick-up, then join parents in the schoolyard.
9. The parent collects the child in person. Responsibility transfers to the parent at this moment.
10. The teacher keeps a brief record of students collected and students remaining in the Afterschool Programme.

Afterschool Programme Pick-Up (16:30 – 17:00)

11. Arrive between 16:30 and 17:00. The school closes at 17:00.
12. Enter the school building and knock quietly on the door of the activity room.
13. Please enter quietly, the teacher may be mid-activity with students.
14. The parent collects the child in person. Responsibility transfers at the moment of collection.

> Students not collected by 17:00: the Director is immediately informed and decides on next steps.
>
> Repeated late collection will be addressed formally with the family.

Roles and Responsibilities at Pick-Up

Who	Responsibilities at 14:40
Teacher	Ends class exactly at 14:40. Accompanies students to the exit. Monitors pick-up and verifies authorised escorts. Directs Afterschool Programme students immediately to the responsible educator. Keeps a brief record of students picked up vs. staying.
Secretary	Present at the school entrance throughout pick-up. Does NOT escort children to vehicles, parents are required to collect in person. If a parent is delayed, the student waits with the secretary. Logs delayed pick-up times. Notifies the Director/pedagogue if delay exceeds 15 minutes.
Janitor	Opens parking gate at 14:30. Allows max. 2 vehicles simultaneously. Monitors traffic safety in the school yard. Closes parking gate by 14:55. Reports any incidents to the secretary.
Parent / Guardian	Arrives on time at 14:45. Collects child in person from the schoolyard. Respects traffic rules in the school yard. Notifies school in advance if a different person will collect the child.

Special Situations

Situation	What happens
Parent delayed < 15 min	Student waits with the school secretary. Secretary logs the time.
Parent delayed > 15 min	Secretary notifies the Director and/or school pedagogue. Joint decision on further steps.
Student not picked up by 15:00	Director is contacted and decides on next course of action. Parents are called immediately.
Different person collecting	Parent must notify the school in advance, in writing or by phone. Staff will verify identity. An ID may be requested.
Emergency (child illness, accident)	Secretary immediately contacts parents. Director/pedagogue is informed. Normal pick-up procedure may be overridden.
Independent departure (Izjava)	Student may leave independently at 14:40 only if a written Declaration of Independent Departure (Izjava o samostalnom odlasku) is on file. No exceptions without this document.

KEY RULE, Third-party collection:

If anyone other than the listed parent/guardian is collecting your child,

you MUST notify the school in advance, in writing or by phone.

Staff will verify identity. An ID may be requested.

The school will not release a child to an unannounced third party.

Authorised Escort List

Every student must have a current authorised escort list on file at the school. School staff will not release a student to any person not on this list. Families are responsible for keeping this information up to date at all times. Staff may request a photo ID from any person collecting a child, if that person is not known to them.

Changes to the Daily Routine

Any change to the standard pick-up or drop-off arrangement must be communicated to the Head of Education AND the class teacher no later than the day before. This includes:

- Early or late pick-up or drop-off
- A person not on the authorised escort list collecting the student
- A student not participating in a specific school activity or field trip

For last-minute emergency changes:

Call immediately: +387 60 345 1275 or +387 33 560 520

Or email: pedagogy@idss.ba

Do NOT rely on email alone for urgent same-day changes, always call.

Health

IDSS is committed to the health, safety, and wellbeing of every student. The policies in this section are based on the IDSS Rulebook on Procedures in Emergency Medical Situations (June 2025), the Protocol on Illness and Injury, and the Rulebook on School Food. All staff are trained in first aid annually by certified instructors.

MEDICAL EMERGENCY, call immediately:

Ambulance (Hitna pomoć): 124

IDSS Emergency Line: +387 60 345 1275

IDSS General: +387 33 560 520

School address: ul. Buka 13, 71 000 Sarajevo

Health Records, Required on Enrolment

Every student must have a current health record on file before their first day at IDSS. The record must include:

- Basic health information
- Known allergies and chronic conditions
- Emergency contact details for parents/guardians
- Contact details for the child's paediatrician
- Signed parental consent for emergency medical treatment

Physical examinations are required for all students entering Preschool and Grade 1, and for all new students at any grade. Health records must be submitted before the first school day. Parents are responsible for updating the school immediately whenever health information changes.

Medication Policy

Students must not carry medication to or from school. If a student requires medication during school hours, the following rules apply:

- **Medication must be handed in by a parent or guardian** to a member of staff, never sent in a child's bag.
- A signed parental authorisation letter must accompany the physician's written prescription.
- Staff may administer only the specific medication indicated, at the dosage and time specified by the physician.
- **Teachers are strictly prohibited** from administering any medication on their own initiative, without parental consent and a physician's instruction.
- Emergency medications (EpiPen for anaphylaxis, inhaler for asthma) may be held by the school on behalf of a student, with written parental consent and a physician's letter.

When to Keep Your Child at Home

A sick child in school risks infecting classmates and staff, and is unable to learn effectively. Please keep your child at home when any of the following apply:

Symptom	Action required
Fever, currently or within last 24 hours	Keep home. Must be fever-free for 24 hours before returning.
Vomiting, within last 24 hours	Keep home.
Diarrhoea or stomach pain	Keep home until symptom-free.
Severe nasal discharge + persistent cough	Keep home.
Sore throat	Keep home.
Unidentified skin rash	Keep home. Medical assessment recommended.
Head lice / nits suspected or confirmed	Do not bring to school. Call school immediately.

Returning to school after illness:

- Fever: child must be fever-free for a full 24 hours before returning, without fever-reducing medication.
- Vomiting: child must not have vomited for 24 hours before returning.
- All absences due to illness must be reported to the school on the day (see Attendance section).
- A medical note is required for repeated illness absences.

Head Lice

If head lice or nits are suspected or confirmed, do not bring your child to school and call the school immediately. IDSS will check all students and staff. A student found to have head lice will be sent home and may return only once parents confirm in writing that treatment has been completed and the child is clear.

Allergies

All allergies must be reported to the school before the child's first day and updated promptly as new allergies develop. This information is held confidentially and shared only with relevant staff on a need-to-know basis.

- The school kitchen takes all reported allergies into account when planning menus.
- Do not bring pets to school premises. Pets may trigger allergic reactions in students with animal allergies.

- IDSS may occasionally bring animals to school for educational purposes. Parents will be notified in advance.
- **Students with severe allergies** (e.g. anaphylaxis risk) must have an EpiPen on file at the school, with written consent from parents and a physician's letter authorising its use.

Excuses from Physical Education

A student unable to participate in Physical Education due to illness or injury must present a doctor's note specifying the start and end dates of the exemption. If no end date is given, a further note confirming the student is medically cleared to resume all activities must be provided on the day of return. A child who returns to school with physical restrictions must bring a doctor's note on the first day back.

Medical Emergency Procedure

In any medical emergency, IDSS staff follow the six-step procedure established in the Emergency Medical Response Policy (June 2025, School Board):

Step	Action	Detail
1	**Assess**	Quickly assess severity. Identify type of injury or health problem. Determine if emergency services are needed.
2	**Secure**	Remove hazards from immediate area. Ensure other students are safe and supervised. Evacuate if necessary.
3	**First Aid**	Provide first aid appropriate to the situation. Use first aid kit. Do not move the injured person unless essential for safety.
4	**Call 124**	Call emergency services. State the situation clearly. Give address: ul. Buka 13, 71000 Sarajevo. Follow dispatcher instructions.
5	**Notify**	Inform the school Director. Contact parents/guardians. Notify relevant authorities if required (police, fire).
6	**Document**	After stabilisation: complete the incident report form. Collect witness statements. File in student record and school archive.

AMBULANCE PROTOCOL, IDSS policy:

- Staff call 124 (ambulance) FIRST, then notify parents.
- IDSS staff are not authorised to decide which hospital the student is taken to.

  That decision rests solely with the emergency physician.
- Parents are informed as soon as the ambulance has been called.
- Every incident is documented in writing and filed in the student record.

Specific Emergency Situations

Staff are trained to respond to the following situations in accordance with the IDSS Emergency Medical Rulebook:

Situation	Key response
Loss of consciousness	Check breathing and pulse. Place in recovery position if breathing. Begin CPR if no breathing/pulse. Call 124.
Choking (age 1+)	Apply Heimlich manoeuvre. Continue until obstruction clears or person loses consciousness. Call 124.
Choking (under age 1)	Up to 5 back blows, then up to 5 chest compressions. Call 124.
Epileptic seizure	Clear area. Do not put anything in mouth. Time the seizure. Recovery position after. Call 124 if > 5 minutes or repeated.
Severe allergic reaction	Remove allergen. Apply EpiPen if available and authorised. Call 124. Semi-recumbent position. Prepare for CPR.
High fever (> 38°C)	Remove excess clothing. Cool environment. Offer fluids. Cool compress. Antipyretic only with parental consent. Call 124 if > 39°C.
Serious injury / bleeding	Apply direct pressure to stop bleeding. Immobilise. Do not remove foreign bodies from wound. Cover with sterile gauze. Monitor vitals. Call 124.

First Aid Equipment

IDSS maintains fully stocked first aid kits in accessible, clearly marked locations throughout the school. Contents are checked regularly and restocked as needed. At least one staff member trained in first aid is present on school premises at all times. The kit contains: sterile gauze and bandages, plasters, antiseptic, thermometer, disposable gloves, scissors, tweezers, and a list of emergency contact numbers.

Food & Nutrition

IDSS operates its own fully-equipped kitchen. All food preparation complies strictly with HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points) food safety standards. Weekly menus are planned in collaboration with a qualified nutritionist to ensure balanced, age-appropriate, and nutritious meals for every student, every day.

Meals Included, At a Glance

What is provided depends on the group your child belongs to and whether they are enrolled in the Afterschool Programme. The table below gives a precise overview:

Meal / Time	Preschool Group	Grades 1–9 (standard day)	Grades 1–9 (Afterschool Programme)
Breakfast 08:45 – 09:05	✓ Included in tuition	– Not in tuition. Available on request: 50,00 KM/month. Or bring from home.	– Not in tuition. Available on request: 50,00 KM/month. Or bring from home.
Hot Lunch 11:30 – 12:15	✓ Included in tuition	✓ Included in tuition	✓ Included in tuition
Afternoon Snack 14:40 – 15:15	✓ Included in tuition	– Not provided. (Standard day ends at 14:45.)	✓ Included in Afterschool fee

PRESCHOOL GROUP, Full board included in tuition:

Breakfast (08:45 – 09:05) ✓ Included

Hot Lunch (11:30 – 12:15) ✓ Included

Afternoon Snack (14:40 – 15:15) ✓ Included

No additional food charges apply for Preschool students.

GRADES 1–9, Standard tuition covers:

Hot Lunch (11:30 – 12:15) ✓ Included in tuition

Breakfast ✗ NOT included in tuition.

→ Parents may register for school breakfast: 50,00 KM/month (billed separately).

→ Alternatively, students may bring their own breakfast from home.

Afternoon Snack ✗ NOT included in standard tuition.

→ Provided only for students enrolled in the Afterschool Programme (included in that fee).

General Food Rules

- Students may not share food with classmates.
- Sweets, chewing gum, and sugary snacks are not permitted at school.
- Please pack sufficient nutritious food when your child brings breakfast from home.
- Allergen information: inform the school of all food allergies before the first day of school. The kitchen will be notified. See the Health section for details.

Birthdays

Every student's birthday is acknowledged with a class song and a small celebration. For a birthday cake, two options are available:

- **School kitchen:** Order in advance by contacting Nermin. Cost: 50,00 KM. The kitchen will prepare the cake to HACCP standards.
- **External bakery:** Parents may bring a cake from a bakery. The cake's hygiene/origin certificate must be presented to the school upon delivery.

If you are organising a birthday party outside school, please invite inclusive groups (the whole class, all boys, or all girls) rather than a partial selection, exclusion has a strong impact on children's social wellbeing. Birthday invitations should be distributed via email or phone, not at school.

Dress code

The IDSS dress code is based on the School Code of Conduct (Art. 5q and Art. 10e–f, October 2024). Its purpose is to ensure a focused, respectful, and safe learning environment for all students. Students are expected to dress in a clean, modest, and age-appropriate manner every school day.

Clothing, What Is and Is Not Permitted

✓ Acceptable	✗ Not permitted (Policy, Art. 10)
Clean, age-appropriate clothing	Ripped or torn trousers/jeans
Comfortable, practical footwear	Skirts or shorts more than 5 cm above the knee
Modest necklines and covered shoulders	Crop tops or tops that do not cover the stomach
Simple, small jewellery	Low-cut or strapless tops
Neat, natural hair	Transparent / see-through clothing
Clean, unvarnished nails	Makeup, artificial nails, varnished nails
	Piercings (visible)
	Dyed hair
	Expensive or bulky jewellery / valuables
	Display of religious symbols

Dress code applies every school day, to all students in all grades.

Staff may address inappropriate clothing at any time.

Repeated violations are treated as a breach of school rules and parents will be informed.

Shoes, Two Pairs Required Every Day

Every student must bring TWO pairs of shoes to school every day. This is a mandatory requirement based on the School Code of Conduct and applies to ALL grades, ALL days, without exception.

INDOOR SHOES, MANDATORY:

Every student must wear indoor shoes inside the school building at all times.

Outdoor shoes are stored in the wardrobe shelves at the school entrance.

Indoor shoes must be: comfortable, anti-slip, and easy to put on and take off independently.

Flip-flops are NOT suitable as indoor shoes.

Please label your child's indoor shoes clearly with their full name.

OUTDOOR / SPORTS SHOES:

Students must wear weatherproof outdoor shoes to and from school, we go outside every day.

Trainers / sneakers are required for Physical Education lessons (FIS Sports Centre).

PE trainers must be suitable for both indoor court and outdoor surfaces.

Jewellery & Accessories

Small, simple jewellery is acceptable. Please avoid jewellery that is:

- Loud or jangling, it disrupts lessons
- Easily broken, safety risk during physical activity
- Bulky, interferes with writing or handling equipment
- Expensive or high-value, IDSS does not accept responsibility for loss or theft of valuables

Piercings, visible religious symbols, and excessively expensive accessories are not permitted under the Policy (Art. 5q).

Mobile Phones & Electronic Devices

The use of mobile phones and other audio/video recording devices during school hours is strictly prohibited under the School Code of Conduct (Art. 5s–t). The procedure is as follows:

Step	Mobile phone procedure (Policy, Art. 5t)
On arrival	Student hands in mobile phone(s) and any audio/video recording device at the school secretary's or pedagogue's office.
During school	Devices are stored in designated, supervised lockers. Any use during lessons is strictly prohibited.
On departure	Student collects device(s) from the same office when leaving school.
Multiple devices	Bringing more than one device is not permitted. If brought, all devices must be handed in.
Responsibility	IDSS does not accept responsibility for theft, loss, or damage to devices.

A teacher may confiscate a device used during a lesson and hand it to the Director or

school pedagogue. The student may collect it from the Director/pedagogue after classes.

The class teacher will inform the parent/guardian of the violation.

ITEMS TO BRING & NOT TO BRING

The following lists are based on the School Code of Conduct and the Policy on the Use of School Premises and Equipment. Families are responsible for ensuring their child has the required items every day.

✓ Required, bring every day	Notes
Backpack	Large enough for a standard folder and lunch box; small enough for the child to carry independently.
Indoor shoes	Worn inside the building. Anti-slip, comfortable. Labelled with child's name.
Outdoor / weatherproof shoes	Worn to/from school and outside. Changed at the wardrobe on arrival.
Water bottle	Taken home, cleaned, and refilled each day.
PE trainers	Required on PE days. Indoor/outdoor suitable. Keep in school bag on PE days.
Changing clothes (Preschool only)	Labelled bag: socks, underwear, trousers, T-shirt, long-sleeved shirt.

✗ Do NOT bring	Reason
Toys and collectable cards	Cause disputes; IDSS not responsible for loss.
Chewing gum	Prohibited under Policy (Art. 5m).
Sweets and excessive sugary snacks	Not permitted; disrupts healthy eating culture.
Mobile phones (see above)	Must be handed in at entry. Strictly regulated.
Comic books	Not relevant to the learning environment.
Valuables (expensive jewellery, cash, electronics)	IDSS does not accept responsibility for theft or loss.
Weapons, flammables, dangerous objects	Strictly prohibited by law and school rules.

Alcohol, narcotics	Strictly prohibited by law and school rules.

> IDSS does not accept responsibility for theft or loss of items not permitted in school, or for loss of personal valuables brought to school at the family's own risk.
> (School Code of Conduct, Art. 5 and Art. 10)

Lost & Found

Found items are collected and placed in the Lost & Found box located on the ground floor next to the staircase. The box is cleared on the last day of each month, unclaimed items are donated or disposed of.

- Please label ALL personal items: outdoor clothing, shoes, backpacks, lunch boxes, and water bottles with your child's full name.
- IDSS is not responsible for unlabelled items that cannot be returned to their owner.

No Toys Policy

Please refrain from bringing toys and collectable cards to school. Students become easily upset about losing, trading, sharing, and storing toys, these items are best kept at home. IDSS is not responsible for lost items brought from home without the teacher's prior approval.

Use of School Premises & Equipment

All students and families are expected to treat school property with care and respect. This is grounded in the Policy on the Use of School Premises and Equipment (October 2024):

- Use school equipment carefully and only for its intended purpose.
- Report any damage or malfunction immediately to the teacher, secretary, or janitor.
- Students are responsible for returning teaching aids and school supplies to their designated place after each lesson.
- Any damage caused by negligent or improper use must be compensated by the responsible party.
- Students must not write on walls, desks, or school inventory.

DAILY STRUCTURE & SCHOOL RULES

Wardrobe

1. Put belongings away neatly, outdoor shoes in shelves, bags and coats on hooks.
2. Change into indoor shoes immediately upon arrival.
3. Use an inside voice.

Arriving Time (07:30 – 07:55) & Breaks in the Classroom

4. Choose an activity and find an area to settle quietly.
5. Ask a teacher for permission before leaving the room.
6. Put supplies away neatly.
7. Use an inside voice.

Lunchroom

8. Tidy school materials in the classroom before heading to the lunchroom.
9. Follow your teacher to the lunchroom.
10. Find your seat quickly and quietly.
11. Lunch starts together when all students are ready.
12. Place plates in the designated area when finished.

Schoolyard

13. Follow your teacher to the wardrobe and get ready quietly.
14. Treat equipment with respect and return it neatly.
15. Respect everyone's personal space.
16. Do not hide in bushes or behind structures.
17. When the break ends, line up and follow your teacher back inside.

Rules during Lessons

18. Raise your hand when you wish to speak.
19. Listen attentively to the speaker.
20. Use materials with care.
21. Use an inside voice and speak the correct language of instruction.

Behaviour policies

IDSS is committed to a safe, respectful, and responsible learning environment. We maintain clear expectations and review them regularly with students to ensure everyone can do their best work.

The Six General IDSS Rules:

22. Use respectful and polite language at all times.
23. Treat everyone, peers, staff, and visitors, with respect.
24. Listen attentively when others are speaking.
25. Ask permission before leaving any room.
26. Use all materials and equipment with care.
27. Follow directions given by staff.

When students have difficulty meeting expectations, logical consequences follow. Patterns of misconduct prompt a parent meeting. In serious cases, parents are called immediately.

Discipline is always age-appropriate and case-specific. In extreme circumstances, IDSS reserves the right to suspend or, as a last resort, expel a student. We believe strongly in school-family partnership to guide every child in the right direction.

ACADEMIC PROGRAMME

IDSS delivers a dual-track curriculum aligned with the educational standards of the German federal states of Baden-Württemberg and Thüringen, harmonised with the Law on Education in Sarajevo Canton (Sl. novine KS br. 27/24). Instruction is conducted in German, English, and B/H/S across all grades. The programme covers Grades 1–9 as well as the Preschool Group.

Programme languages: German (DE) • English (EN) • Bosnian/Croatian/Serbian (BSH) • French (FR, from Grade 6)

Total weekly lessons per student: 35 (all grades)

Each lesson: 45 minutes, with 5-minute transitions between subjects

Timetable is published at least one week before the start of each school year: idss.edu.ba

Primary School, Weekly Lessons (Grades 1–4)

Subject / Language	Gr 1	Gr 2	Gr 3	Gr 4
German (DE)	5	5	5	5
Mathematics (DE)	5	5	5	5
English (EN)	4	4	5	5
BSH (BSH)	4	4	4	4
Social Science (DE)	2	2	2	2
My Environment (DE)	2	2	2	2
Physical Education (EN)	2	2	2	2
Art (DE)	2	2	2	2
Music (EN)	1	1	1	1
Ethics (DE)	1	1	1	1
Support (DE)	7	7	6	6
TOTAL	**35**	**35**	**35**	**35**

Note: *Grades 1 and 2 also receive a daily 15-minute German language circle. Physical Education lessons are held at the FIS Sport and Recreation Centre Sarajevo.*

Middle School, Weekly Lessons (Grades 5–9)

Subject / Language	Gr 5	Gr 6	Gr 7	Gr 8	Gr 9
German (DE)	5	5	5	5	5
Mathematics (EN)	5	5	5	4	4
English (EN)	5	4	4	4	4
French (FR)	–	2	2	2	2
BSH (BSH)	4	5	4	4	3
Informatics (EN)	1	1	1	1	1
Nature / Biology (DE)	2	1	2	1	2
Geography (EN)	–	2	2	2	2
History (EN)	–	1	1	2	2
Physics (EN)	–	–	1	2	2
Chemistry (EN)	–	–	–	2	2
Physical Education (EN)	2	2	2	2	2
Art (DE)	1	1	1	1	1
Music (EN)	1	1	1	1	1
Ethics (DE)	1	1	1	1	1
Technical Education (EN)	–	1	1	1	1
Support (DE)	5	3	2	–	–
TOTAL	**35**	**35**	**35**	**35**	**35**

Note: *Physical Education lessons are held at the FIS Sport and Recreation Centre Sarajevo. French is introduced from Grade 6.*

Teaching Methods & Approach

IDSS employs a diverse range of evidence-based teaching methodologies to ensure effective learning and the development of all students:

- Interactive and discussion-based teaching
- Project-based and research-based learning
- Collaborative group work and peer learning
- Individualised instruction and differentiated support
- Integration of digital technologies
- Practical experiments and hands-on activities
- Field trips and educational excursions

IDSS Preschool Group

The IDSS Preschool Group offers a German-language immersion programme from the earliest age, following a daily routine aligned with the International Montessori House (IMH) calendar. The curriculum develops language (German from day one), numeracy, social-emotional skills, creativity, and early independence. Children learn through play, projects, daily rituals, and outdoor exploration.

The preschool prepares children seamlessly for transition into Grade 1 of the primary programme. Full board (breakfast, lunch, and afternoon snack) is included in the Preschool tuition fee.

General Daily Routine, Preschool

Morning:

- Children arrive and are welcomed by teachers and staff
- Free play and exploration time, building with blocks, drawing, or playing with toys
- Circle time, songs, stories, and discussions about the day's activities

Mid-morning:

- Snack time, nutritious snack; practising sharing and taking turns
- Teacher-led activities, name writing, early numeracy and language concepts
- Story time, a new book or a favourite story read aloud
- Outdoor playtime, running, jumping, and games to develop gross motor skills

Lunchtime:

- Hot lunch provided by the school kitchen (HACCP-certified, nutritionist-approved)
- Quiet time, rest, reading, or puzzles

Afternoon:

- Free play and exploration, continuing chosen activities or trying new ones
- Teacher-led group activity, science experiment, art project, or music lesson
- Closing circle, children say goodbye, review the day's activities, and prepare for dismissal

Throughout the day, preschool teachers monitor and assess children's progress and adjust activities to meet individual needs. They encourage positive social interactions and maintain a safe, nurturing environment for all children.

Inclusive Education, Students with Special Needs

IDSS is committed to inclusive education for all students, in accordance with the Policy on the Organization of Instruction for Students with Special Educational Needs (October 2024). Special educational needs are identified through a multi-disciplinary team comprising the school pedagogue, psychologist, subject teachers, and, where needed, external specialists.

- Individual Educational Programmes (IEP) are developed for students who require them.
- Needs are identified before enrolment or at any point during schooling, at the initiative of parents, teachers, or specialists.

- IDSS adapts teaching methods, materials, and assessment to meet individual needs.
- Parents are full partners in the IEP process and are kept regularly informed of progress.

Families who believe their child may have special educational needs are encouraged to contact the school pedagogue as early as possible.

Assessments & Examinations

Assessment at IDSS is continuous, varied, and designed to support learning as well as measure it. It includes formative assessment during lessons, summative exams, project work, oral and written tests, and self- and peer-evaluation.

Grade	Exam policy
Preschool & Grade 1	No written exams.
Grade 2	Written exams begin in Semester 2 only.
Grade 3	Homework and exams begin in October.
Grades 4–9	Written exams on a published schedule, announced in advance.

> One week before each exam: teacher emails families with exam content and preparation tips.
>
> Graded exams are returned within 1 week. Students take them home for parents to review,
>
> sign, and return to school. Unsatisfactory results trigger a parent–teacher discussion.

Homework

Grade	Homework policy
Preschool & Grade 1	No homework.
Grade 2	Homework begins in Semester 2 only.
Grade 3	Homework begins in October.
Grades 4–9	Regular homework aligned to lessons.

How families best support homework at home:

- Provide a quiet, distraction-free workspace, no TV or loud music.
- Help establish a daily routine: same time, same place.
- Encourage a work ethic, even 10 focused minutes daily makes a difference.

- Check that homework is completed, but do not do it for the child.
- Read with your child or encourage independent reading: 5–10 minutes per language per day.

Non-obligatory summer homework is set at the end of the school year to help maintain learning momentum over the holidays.

Grading System

IDSS uses the German 6-point grading scale, aligned with the standards of Baden-Württemberg and Thüringen, and converted to the Bosnian-Herzegovinian scale for official school certificates. The minimum passing grade is 3 (befriedigend / dobar).

German Grade	German Label	Bosnian Grade	Level
1	sehr gut (excellent)	5, odličan	**Excellent ✓**
2	gut (good)	4, vrlo dobar	**Good**
3	befriedigend (satisfactory)	3, dobar	**Satisfactory ✓ (pass)**
4	ausreichend (sufficient)	2, dovoljan	**Sufficient (pass)**
5	mangelhaft (deficient)	1, nedovoljan	Insufficient (fail)
6	ungenügend (insufficient)	1, nedovoljan	Insufficient (fail)

Official school certificates (svjedodžbe) are issued at the end of each semester for all students.

Students receive a Bosnian-Herzegovinian certificate with grades converted as shown above.

Certificates are distributed to students on the last day of each semester.

Textbooks, Materials & Digital Tools

IDSS carefully selects learning resources from reputable international and national publishers, including Cornelsen, Deutsche Fernschule, Schulexpert, Oxford University Press, Carson Dellosa, CLE International, Sarajevo Publishing, Schöningh, Lernwelt, and Didier. All textbooks and workbooks are provided to students; additional costs are communicated at enrolment.

Digital tools, including Microsoft OneDrive, MagicSchool AI, and ChatGPT, are integrated thoughtfully and age-appropriately. All digital use is supervised. Students are educated in responsible and safe use of technology as part of the regular curriculum (see Dress Code section for mobile phone policy).

Extracurricular Activities

IDSS offers a structured Afterschool Programme (15:15–17:00) and a range of extracurricular activities designed to develop the whole child, intellectually, creatively, physically, and socially. Activities are planned at the start of each school year and run at least weekly. The programme goes beyond homework assistance.

Area	Activities
Foreign Languages	Acting, gardening, journalism, cooking, and other language-enrichment sections
STEM	Hands-on science, technology, engineering, and mathematics projects
Music & Drama	Performance, self-expression, and collaborative arts
Sports	Football, basketball, volleyball, gymnastics, physical fitness and team spirit
Arts & Crafts	Visual art workshops, creative projects, exhibitions
Community	Volunteering, ecological projects, social responsibility activities

For full details on the Afterschool Programme, including enrolment and fees, visit idss.edu.ba/afternoon-program or contact info@idss.ba.

Field Trips & Project Week

- **Field trips** are organised throughout the year. Families are notified by email in advance with full details on destination, purpose, and preparation. An additional fee applies; the amount varies by trip.
- **Project Week** (22–25 May 2027) is an interdisciplinary learning week in which students work in teams on cross-curricular tasks, developing critical thinking, research skills, and presentation abilities.
- **Summer School** (2–13 August 2027) is an optional enrichment programme for ages 6–15, combining German language instruction, sports, arts, and cultural excursions around Sarajevo. Spaces are limited, early registration is advised.

PHYSICAL EDUCATION, FIS SPORT & RECREATION CENTRE

IDSS does not have its own gymnasium on-site. Physical Education lessons for all grades are conducted at the FIS Sport and Recreation Centre Sarajevo, commonly known as FIS, a professional, fully-equipped sports facility.

Key information for parents:

- Students travel to FIS as a class group, accompanied by their teacher. Transport logistics and schedules are communicated at the start of each semester.
- Students must bring appropriate trainers/sneakers to every PE lesson. Trainers must be suitable for both indoor courts and outdoor areas.
- Proper PE kit (sportswear) is required. A spare set may be kept in school.
- If a student cannot participate in PE due to illness or injury, a doctor's note is required (see Health section).
- The FIS facility maintains its own safety and hygiene regulations, which students are expected to respect.

> Reminder: Students must always have their PE bag packed on PE days.
>
> Lost or forgotten equipment cannot be borrowed at FIS.
>
> IDSS is not responsible for items lost at the FIS facility.

OUR PRESCHOOL PROGRAMME

The IDSS preschool immerses children in the German language and culture from the earliest age. Research consistently shows that early bilingualism improves cognitive development, academic performance, and intercultural openness.

The curriculum covers German vocabulary, grammar, sentence structure, and pronunciation, enriched by cultural activities, German songs, cooking, and celebrating German traditions. Children learn through projects, presentations, and daily routines that prepare them seamlessly for Grade 1.

Our teachers promote academic, social, emotional, personal, and methodological competencies in a nurturing, playful environment.

Daily Routine, Preschool

- Morning: Welcome, free play, circle time with songs and stories
- Mid-morning: Nutritious snack, teacher-led activities, story time, outdoor play
- Lunchtime: Healthy school lunch, quiet rest time
- Afternoon: Free exploration, teacher-led group activity (science, art, music), closing circle

Throughout the day, preschool teachers monitor progress and adapt activities to meet each child's individual needs.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES & AFTERSCHOOL PROGRAMME

At IDSS, learning does not end when the school day concludes. Our Afterschool Programme offers a dynamic, enriching extension of the day, providing students with a safe, stimulating environment for continued growth, creativity, and exploration.

The programme features:

- Foreign Language Enrichment, through acting, gardening, journalism, cooking, and other creative sections.
- STEM Activities, hands-on projects in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics.
- Music and Drama, performance, self-expression, and collaborative arts.

Afterschool Programme hours: 15:15 – 17:00. Pick-up window: 16:30 – 17:00.

For more information: https://idss.edu.ba/afternoon-program | +387 33 560 520 | info@idss.ba

Field Trips

Students take various field trips and excursions throughout the year. Families are notified by email in advance with full details on the destination, purpose, and preparation. An additional fee applies; the amount varies by trip and student numbers.

Summer School

The IDSS Summer School runs in the 2nd and 3rd weeks of August, welcoming children aged 6–15. The programme combines German language instruction, creative arts and crafts, sports, and cultural excursions around Sarajevo and beyond, including visits to Bascarsija, Trebevic Mountain, Tito's Bunker in Konjic, ZOO Bambi, and the Pyramid of the Sun in Visoko.

Collaboration with AIESEC International and the Scouts brings additional expertise in teamwork, nature, and global perspective. All students receive a completion certificate, personal progress report, and digital portfolio. Spaces are limited, early registration is strongly recommended. Visit idss.edu.ba or call +387 33 560 520 for details.

PARENT CODE OF CONDUCT

IDSS is a community built on trust, respect, and shared responsibility. Raising thriving children requires active cooperation between families, teachers, and the school. This code is grounded in the School Code of Conduct (Art. 17-18, October 2024) and reflects our belief that every adult in our community is a role model for our students.

What We Ask of Our Families

IDSS families are asked to uphold the following commitments throughout the school year:

Commitment	What it looks like in practice
Dignity & Respect	Treat all staff, students, and other parents with courtesy at all times, even in disagreement.
Active Support	Support your child's daily school life: punctuality, preparation, homework, and a positive attitude.
Engagement	Attend parent–teacher meetings and school events. Read all school communications promptly.
Rules & Deadlines	Adhere to school regulations, calendars, fee deadlines, and procedures. Model this for your child.
Cultural Openness	Respect and embrace the diversity of cultures and beliefs in our community.
Constructive Dialogue	Raise concerns through the appropriate channel. Avoid social media complaints.
Privacy	Do not discuss other children, families, or staff outside formal school settings.
Positive Modelling	Be the example you want your child to follow, in conduct, language, and attitude.

Behaviours the School Will Not Tolerate

In order to protect the safety, dignity, and integrity of our students, staff, and community, IDSS will not tolerate the following from parents, guardians, or other visitors (**Policy**, Art. 17-18):

Prohibited behaviour	Consequence
Shouting at or verbally abusing any staff member, student, or parent	Written warning. Repeated behaviour leads to termination of the education agreement.
Physically intimidating any member of the school community	Immediate removal from the premises. Police may be contacted.
Breaking school security procedures (entering without authorisation)	Immediate removal. School reserves the right to terminate the education agreement.

Defamatory, offensive comments about school, staff, or students, in person or online	Written warning. Serious concerns must go to the Principal or Founder in writing.
Abusive or threatening emails, texts, phone calls, or written communications	Written warning. Legal action may follow in serious cases.
Disruptive behaviour interfering with classrooms, offices, or school grounds	Removal from premises. Director notified immediately.
Offensive, profane, or vulgar language on school premises	Written warning. Repeated behaviour leads to termination.
Consuming alcohol or narcotics on school premises	Immediate removal. Termination of education agreement without notice period.
Threats of physical harm to any member of the school community	Police contacted immediately. Education agreement terminated.

PROCEDURE for serious violations (**Policy**, Art. 18):

1. IDSS issues a written warning to the parent/guardian.
2. If behaviour continues, the Education Agreement is terminated.
3. The parent/guardian may appeal to the School Board within 8 days of receiving the warning.
4. The School Board's decision is final.
5. In cases of immediate threat or harm, IDSS will contact the police without delay.

Online & Social Media

Parents and guardians are asked to refrain from posting complaints, photographs of other students, or commentary about school staff, families, or events on any public social media platform. Any serious concern must be addressed directly and in writing to the Principal or the Founder. The school will take appropriate action in response to defamatory or offensive online content.

Complaints Procedure

We welcome constructive feedback. If you have a concern, please follow this order:

1. Speak directly with the class teacher or relevant staff member.
2. If unresolved, contact the Head of Education: pedagogy@idss.ba
3. If still unresolved, request a meeting with the Principal via email.
4. As a final step, submit a written complaint to the School Board.

Most concerns are resolved promptly and constructively at the first or second level. Parents are expected to follow this process in full.

Acknowledgement of Receipt

Please sign and return this page to the school office
by the end of the first week of school.

I confirm that I have received, read, and understood the IDSS Parent Guide for the school year 2026/2027. I am aware that the content of this Guide may be updated during the year and that I will be informed of any changes by email. I agree to adhere to all policies, procedures, and expectations set out in this Guide.

Name of Student:

Student's Class / Grade:

Name of Parent / Guardian 1:

Signature of Parent / Guardian 1:

Name of Parent / Guardian 2:

Signature of Parent / Guardian 2:

Date:

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

ISO 9001:2015, Quality Management Certification

IDSS holds ISO 9001:2015 certification, the internationally recognised standard for quality management systems. This certification affirms that our processes, from admissions and curriculum delivery to communication and facility management, consistently meet the highest quality standards and are subject to regular independent audit.

HACCP, Food Safety Certification

Our kitchen operates fully in compliance with HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points) standards, the gold standard in food safety management. Every meal prepared in our kitchen follows strict protocols developed and overseen by a qualified nutritionist. Parents can be confident that their children receive safe, nutritious, and balanced meals every day.

Business Leader of Sustainable Development 2025, "People" Category

In 2025, IDSS was proud to receive the prestigious Business Leader of Sustainable Development Award in the thematic category "People". This recognition celebrates our commitment to the wellbeing, development, and empowerment of our students, staff, and wider community. It reflects our belief that people, their potential, dignity, and growth, are at the heart of everything we do.